



Ultrabooks

The greatest driving force in the world of laptops is the push towards making thin, light, sleek and sexy looking notebooks, known simply as ultrabooks. While it's inevitable that the evolution of laptops will mandate thinner, lighter, more powerful machines in the future, it's been an overwhelming push in that direction to realize the future sooner rather than later, as far as ultrabooks are concerned. This year, ultrabooks continued their journey towards packing in more within less – trying to offer the greatest hardware components and performance without upsetting the weighing scales or form factor overmuch. We saw a lot of ultrabooks offering SSD storage by default – a trend that was still a novelty last year. While ultrabook prices have fallen this year, being available at various affordable price points, when it comes to top performance, it's only the highest end ultrabooks that manage to feature into this year's Zero1.

Zero1 Winner

Toshiba Portege Z30t-A

It's difficult to wax lyrical when talking about a tech product these days, but the Toshiba Portege almost succeeded in making us do just that. It's a lovely laptop and has been designed for businessmen, but we would wholeheartedly recommend the device to anyone who wants to get some work done. A Track-Point is something that we'd expect to see only on Lenovo ThinkPads and it's nice to see it here on the Toshiba Portege, as well. It's as good as any Track-



Acer Aspire S7-392

Price: ₹99,999



HP Elitebook 1040 G1

Price: ₹1,49,865

Point we've ever used and is grippy too. Also, if you want to know what close to an ideal laptop keyboard is like, just find a Portege and try it out yourself. It's among the most tactile and responsive keyboards we've used. With an SSD, the performance of this machine is breezy and right up there, but where this device truly shines is with its display. It's quite gorgeous and with a measured contrast ratio of about 700:1, the best we've seen on a laptop yet. Brightness levels are also high at around 200cd/m2, which makes the measured battery life of about 4 hours that much more impressive. What's more? It weighs just 1.18 kg. A true ultrabook, through and through!

Almost won...

Acer Aspire S7-392

The device is very well-built. There is obvious attention to detail and everything about the design feels very polished and refined. The touch-screen on the Aspire S7 is very responsive and a pleasure to use. The measured battery life was slightly low at about 3.5 hours, but that can be attributed to the fact that the device is so slim that it couldn't possibly hold a higher capacity battery. Our battery tests do stress the system considerably so you should expect between 4-5 hours usage from this device at the very most. But in terms of overall performance, the Acer Aspire S7-392 scored just below the Toshiba Portege Z30T-A – not surprising at all, since it has pretty similar high-end components inside, not to mention a 256GB SSD to keep things nice and quick all the time. It weighs a comfortable 1.3 kg, which is one of the lowest we've seen on ultrabooks this year. It's a tough call between the Portege and the Acer Aspire S7 and the Portege Z30T-A. To put it in a nutshell, the Aspire S7 is a better device to show off, while the Portege is a better device to work on.

Respectable third

HP Elitebook 1040 G1

In the world of high-end ultrabooks, where money isn't a consideration, where you desire a thin and light laptop that should hold its own in a boardroom as well as an airport lounge. The EliteBook 1040 G1 is all that and more. Smartly designed, well constructed, with a premium look and feel. The Elitebook 1040 G1 has fast internal hardware, with an SSD thrown into the mix no less, ensuring you don't feel the performance pinch using most business applications. And while we clocked 3 hours 17 minutes of battery in our benchmark tests, the EliteBook 1040 G1 is still not the fastest ultrabook we've tested this year. It's fast, faster than most laptops you'll encounter, but just not the fastest. 



TOSHIBA PORTEGE Z30T-A ▶

Price: ₹1,00,000

